

[Gap: Lost account of Enlil's wrath at finding survivors and his mollification by Enki.]

"You here have sworn
by the life's breath of heaven
the life's breath of earth
that he verily is allied with you yourself;
you there, An and Enlil,
have sworn by the life's breath of heaven,
the life's breath of earth,
that he is allied with all of you.
He will disembark the small animals
that come up from the earth!"

Ziusudra, being king,
stepped up before An and Enlil
kissing the ground,
And An and Enlil after hono[ring him]
(180') were granting him life like a god's,
were making lasting breath of life, like a god's,
descend into him.
That day they made Ziusudra,
preserver, as king, of the name of the small
animals and the seed of mankind,
live toward the east over the mountains
in Mount Dilmun.

Hallo, William W. and Younger, K. Lawson (1997). [*The Context of Scripture, Volume 1: Canonical Compositions from the Biblical World*](#). Brill Academic Publishers.

The Babyloniaca of Berossus

Language: Greek / Date: 3rd century B.C.E.

[54] Kronos appeared to Xisuthrus in a dream and revealed that on the fifteenth of the month Daisios mankind would be destroyed by a great flood. He then ordered him to bury together all the tablets, the first, the middle, and the last, and hide them in Sippar, the city of the sun. Then he was to build a boat and board it with his family and best friends. He was to provision it with food and drink and also to take on board wild animals and birds and all four-footed animals. Then when all was prepared, he was to make ready to sail. If asked where he was going, he was to reply, "To the gods, to pray that all good things will come to man." He did not stop working until the ship was built. Its length was five stades (one kilometer) and its breadth two (400 m). He boarded the finished ship, equipped for everything as he had been commanded, with his wife, children, and closest friends.

After the waters of the Great Flood had come and quickly left, Xisuthrus freed several birds. They found neither food nor a place to rest, and they returned to the ship. After a few days, he again set free some other birds, and they too came back to the ship, but they returned with claws covered with mud. Then later for a third time he set free some other birds, but they did not return to the ship.

[55] Then Xisuthrus knew that the earth had once again appeared.

He broke open a seam on a side of the ship and saw that the ship had come to rest on a mountain. He disembarked, accompanied by his wife and his daughter together with the steersman. He prostrated himself in worship to the earth and set up an altar and sacrificed to the gods.

After this, he disappeared together with those who had left the ship with him. Those who remained on the ship and had not gone out with Xisuthrus, when he and those with him had disembarked, searched for him and called out for him by name all about. But Xisuthrus from then on was seen no more, and then the sound of voice that came from the air gave the instruction that it was their duty to honor the gods and that Xisuthrus, because of the great honor he had shown the gods, had gone to the dwelling place of the gods and that his wife and daughter and the steersman had enjoyed the same honor.

The voice then instructed them to return to Babylonia to go to the city of Sippar, as it was fated for them to do, to dig up the tablets that were buried there and to turn them over to mankind. The place where they had come to rest was the land of Armenia. After they understood all this, they sacrificed to the gods there and went on foot to Babylonia.

To this day a small part of the ship that came to rest in Armenia remains in the Gordyenian Mountains in Armenia and some people go there and scrape off pieces of pitch to keep them as good luck charms.

[56] And those who had arrived in Babylonia dug up the tablets in the city of Sippar and brought them out. They built many cities and erected temples to the gods and again renewed Babylonia.

Burstein, Stanley (1978). [*The Babyloniaca of Berossus*](#). Undena Publications.

Online Concordance Guide

Here are some online resources that will help you see where repetitions occur in the original language.

Biblehub.com

Using <https://biblehub.com/> Biblehub.com is not always intuitive, but it's pretty easy once you learn how to do it. Here are the steps to pull up an interlinear version of the Bible that shows the English next to the Greek or Hebrew.

1. Type in a verse reference in the main top search bar.
2. Once your verse is pulled up, you can read it in many translations.
3. Find and click "Interlin" in the gray bar near the top of the page, and you'll see the verse listed in:
 - Strong's numbers
 - Transliteration
 - Greek/Hebrew/Aramaic
 - Translation
 - Grammar information
4. If you want to search on the original language word to see all the other times it occurs so you can perform your own word study, click on the blue transliteration hyperlink above the original language.
5. You'll see information about the word as well as the total number of times it occurs in the Bible. Click on the hyperlink "Occurrences" and you will find a complete list of verses that contain that word.

Stepbible.org

Stepbible.org is intuitive and really easy to use. Here are the steps to conduct word study searches.

1. Type the biblical book/verse reference into the search bar.
2. You will see your text with all of the main words in hyperlink blue. Hold your cursor over the word you want to study, and you'll see original language information appear on the bottom of the screen. Click on the word to see more.
3. A window will appear giving you dictionary information and a hyperlink "search for this word" to see every time it occurs. Click on that hyperlink.
4. You will see all the verses listed where that Greek/Hebrew/Aramaic word occurs.

Netbible.org

Netbible.org is not a concordance, but it is a great resource for insights from the original language for people who don't know Greek or Hebrew. Here are the steps to access this resource.

1. Go to the website and use the search/browse tools to find the biblical text you want to study.
2. As you read, you will notice hyperlink footnotes in the biblical text related to that word/phrase/verse.
3. Click on a hyperlink, and the window on the right will pull up all kinds of original language information related to the translation and interpretation issues at work in that specific text.

Reflection Question

What sorts of other ancient flood narratives have you heard about, if any? How does comparing these stories with the biblical account help us understand the intentions of the biblical authors?



Module 2: Cosmic Rebellion in the Time of Noah

SESSIONS 7-10

Begin to unpack the story of Noah and the flood, trace its literary design, and discover the identity of the mysterious Nephilim.

Session 7: Design of Genesis 6:1-12

Key Takeaways

- The flood story begins by detailing the corruption of humanity and the land, outlining both a heavenly rebellion and an earthly rebellion as the source of this corruption.
- Genesis 6:1-12 uses repeated words and phrases from Genesis 1-3 to contrast God's good creation against the now ruined land and to compare the rebellion of the humans with the rebellion of the sons of *Elohim*.
- The picture of God's wrath in Genesis 6 is one of a brokenhearted God who hands creation over to the consequences of human and cosmic rebellion.

Cosmic Rebellion in the Time of Noah (Gen. 6:1-12)

The flood story begins with two aligned stories that focus on the corruption of "humanity" (הָאָדָם) in "the land" (הָאָרֶץ). This corruption comes from two sources, considered separately.

1. A heavenly rebellion that leads to an illicit union of spiritual and human beings, leading to the birth of violent warriors.
2. An earthly rebellion of corrupt humans whose evil causes violence that defiles the land.

In both units, there is a narrative describing tragic evil (6:1-2 and 6:5) that leads to a divine speech about Yahweh's response (6:3 and 6:6-7).

Translation and Literary Design of Genesis 6:1-12

The Rebellion of the Sons of Elohim

- a ¹ And it came about, when humanity began to multiply (רַב) on the face of the land ,
b and daughters were born to/for them ,
b' ² the sons of Elohim saw the daughters of humanity that they were good
c and they took wives for themselves, whomever they chose.

- ³ and Yahweh said ,
a "My Spirit/breath will not dwell with humanity forever,
b because he also is flesh;